



category,” Choi noted. “They represent one of the most important form factors for us in the premium market.” Although he refrained from sharing exact sales figures, the message was clear: foldables are now a strategic priority for Samsung.

This ambition is bolstered by ongoing improvements to both hardware and user experience. Both the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 7 and Galaxy Z Flip 7 are lighter than the earlier models. This is despite that both the phones have improved hardware.

A perfect match for AI

As smartphones transition into more intelligent, AI-driven devices, Samsung sees foldable phones as the ideal canvas. The larger internal displays of the Fold series and the compact functionality of the Flip series make them uniquely suited to AI-enhanced multitasking and communication.

Choi explained that the Galaxy Z Fold 7 and Flip 7 are arriving at a time when AI use cases are exploding. From real-time translation and content generation to multitasking and creative workflows, the company believes that foldables provide an experience that bar-type phones simply cannot match.

“The foldable form factor is optimum for mobile AI,” said Choi. Features like Flex Mode, multi-window functionality, and seamless transitions between displays allow users to maximize the capabilities of Galaxy AI in ways that not only improve productivity, but also enhance creativity.

The future of Galaxy AI: Free or Paid?

As AI becomes a central selling point for smartphones, questions have emerged around Samsung’s monetisation plans. Galaxy AI was introduced with the Galaxy S24 series last year and has been integrated across devices, including the new foldables.

While some competitors are exploring a variety of paid tiers for advanced AI features, Samsung appears to be treading rather cautiously. “For consumers who buy Galaxy smartphones, the basic AI features will remain free or come at no additional cost,” said Choi. However, he confirmed that the company is still exploring its strategy for premium AI experiences, including those developed in collaboration with partners.

One notable trend highlighted during the roundtable was the increasingly diverse user base for foldable phones. Initially favored by

professionals such as architects and designers, the Galaxy Fold is now being adopted by a way broader demographic — including university students who not only use it as a phone but a tablet as well.

Internal usage data shows that foldables are preferred for productivity tasks and media consumption. “Users are reviewing documents like PowerPoint slides, or watching Netflix and YouTube more on the Fold than on bar-type phones,” Choi noted. Rather than being limited to a specific profession, foldables are now appealing across a wide spectrum of age groups and occupations.

The Flip, in particular, offers a unique hybrid experience. When closed, it functions as a compact smart device that can still access AI agents and notifications. When opened, it transforms into a full-sized phone, offering versatility that traditional smartphones lack.

No supply chain pressures yet

On the supply chain front, there are some concerns about China’s restrictions on the export of rare earth elements that are critical to smartphone production. Choi was quick to assure that Samsung’s diversified sourcing strategy has helped insulate the company from any near-term disruptions.

“We have long been preparing for different scenarios,” he said. “There has been no production impact due to rare earth supply limitations.” **d**

